

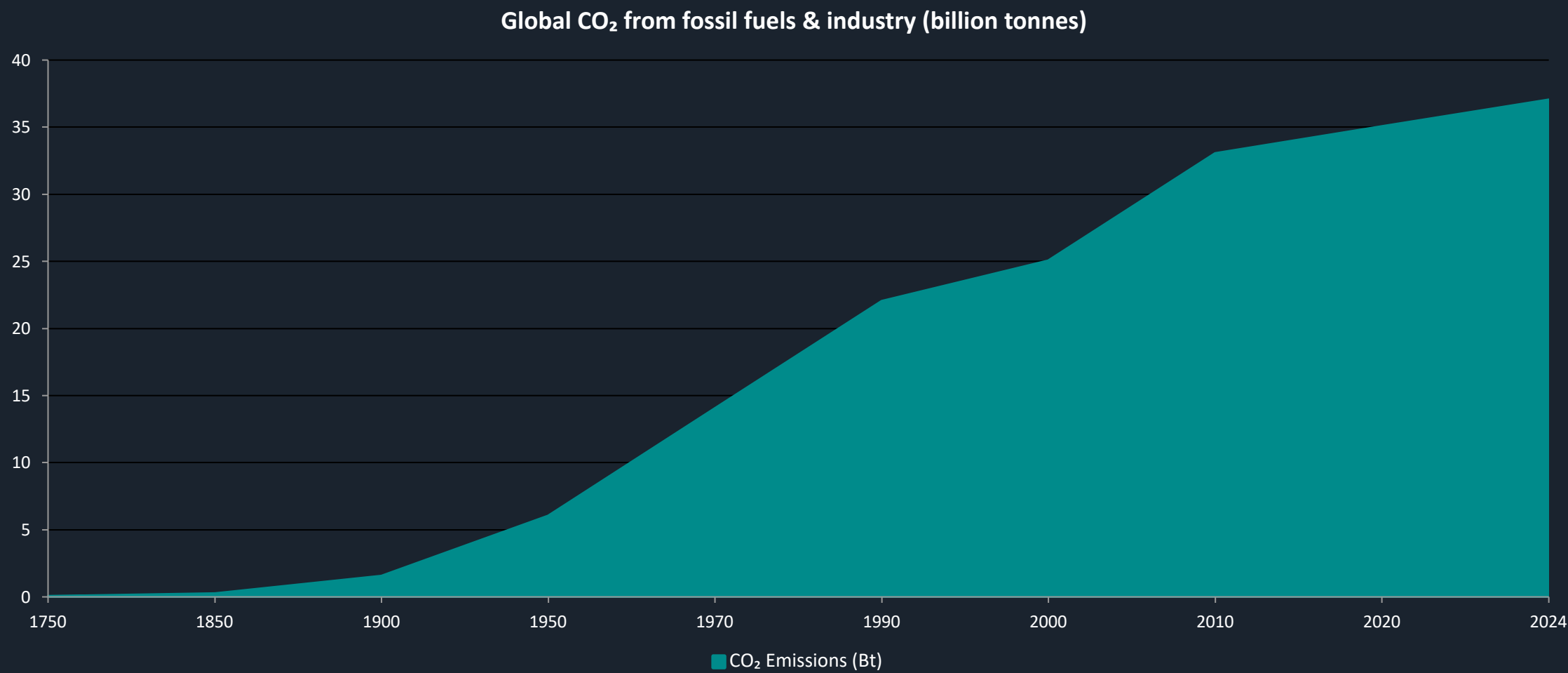
Global CO₂ Emissions: Who Emits, How Much, and What's Changing

Fossil fuels & industry · 1750–2024

Data: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data

Audience: Policy analysts, climate negotiators, and sustainability researchers

Global CO₂ Emissions Grew from 6 Bt in 1950 to Over 35 Bt Today

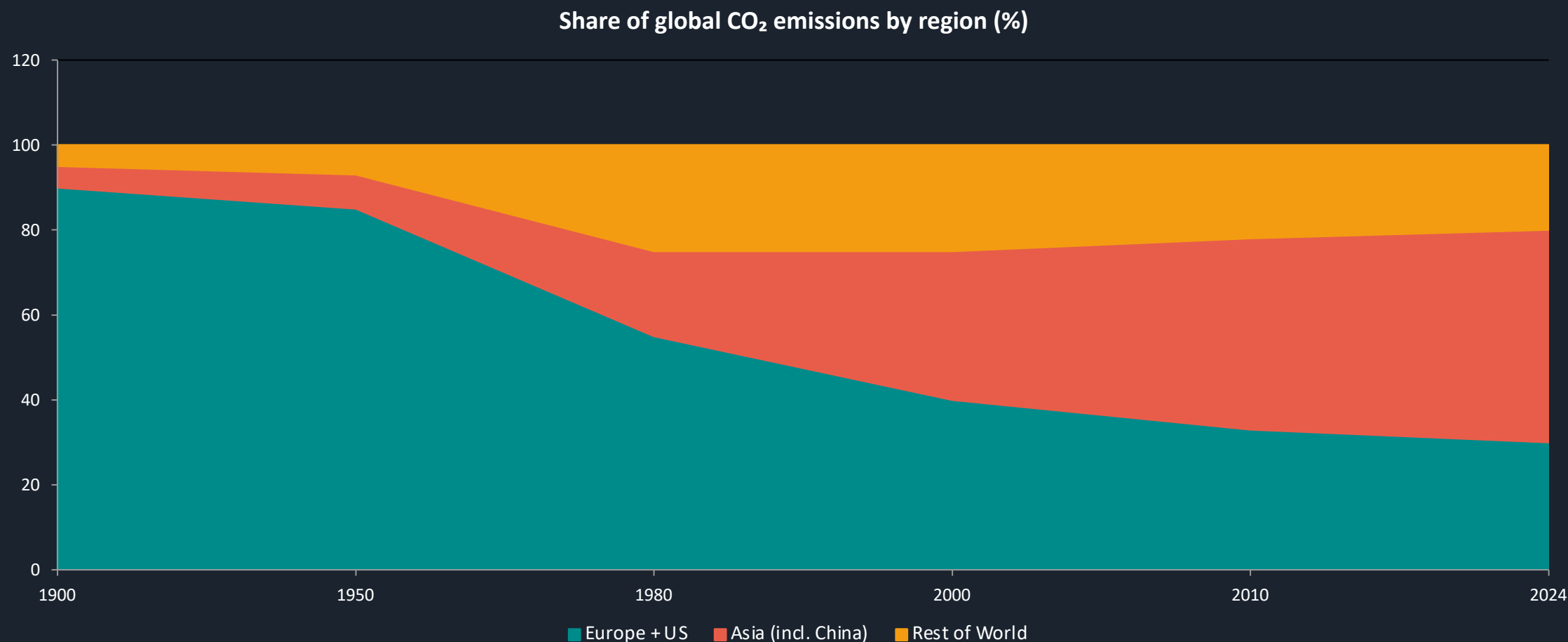


► Pre-industrial: negligible

► Post-1950: rapid acceleration

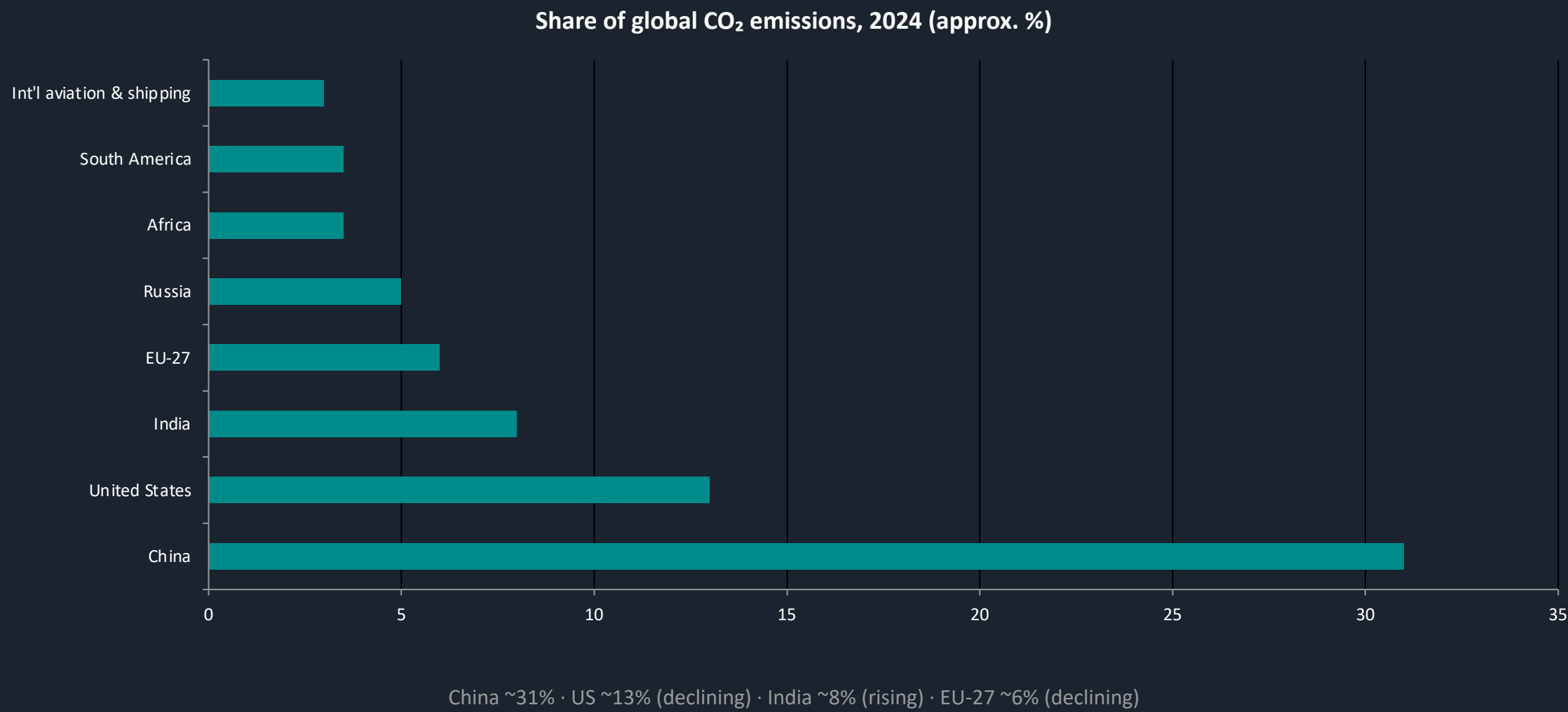
► Recent: slowing, but no peak

Europe and the US Fell from 90% of Emissions in 1900 to Under One-Third Today

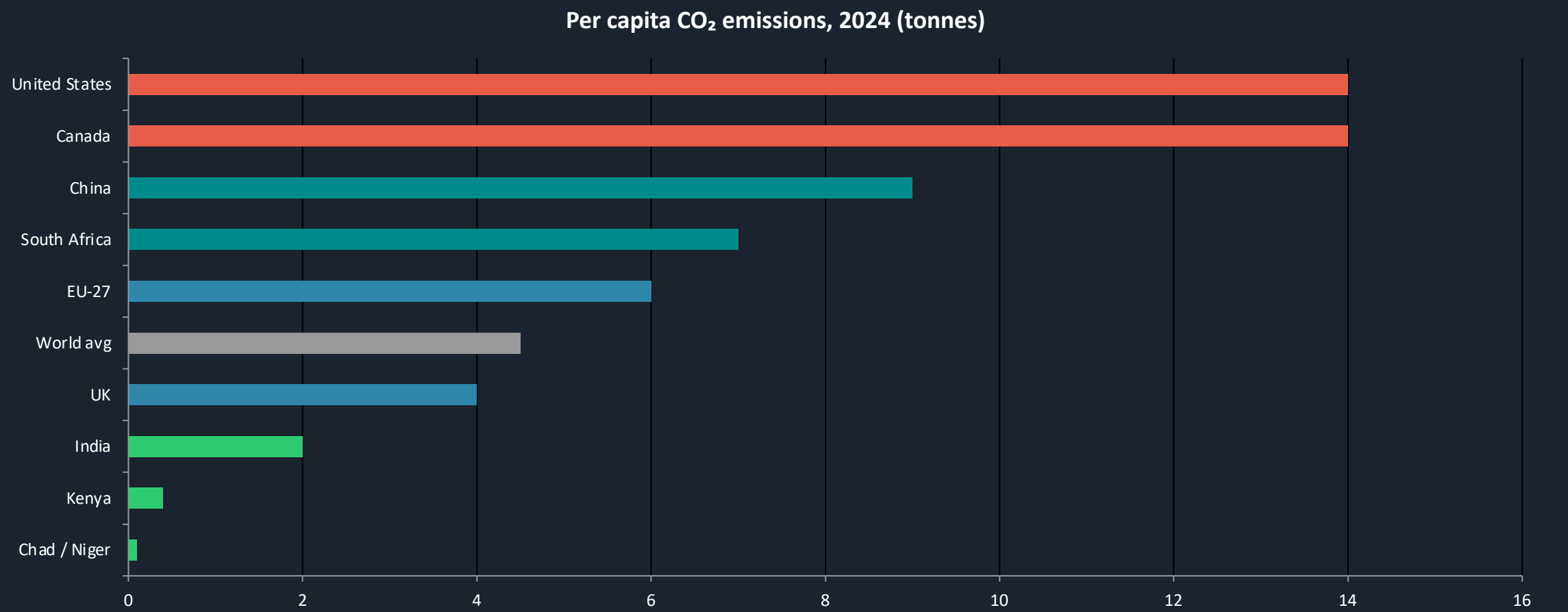


Source: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data · Asia now produces roughly half of global emissions

China Now Emits More Than One-Quarter of Global CO₂

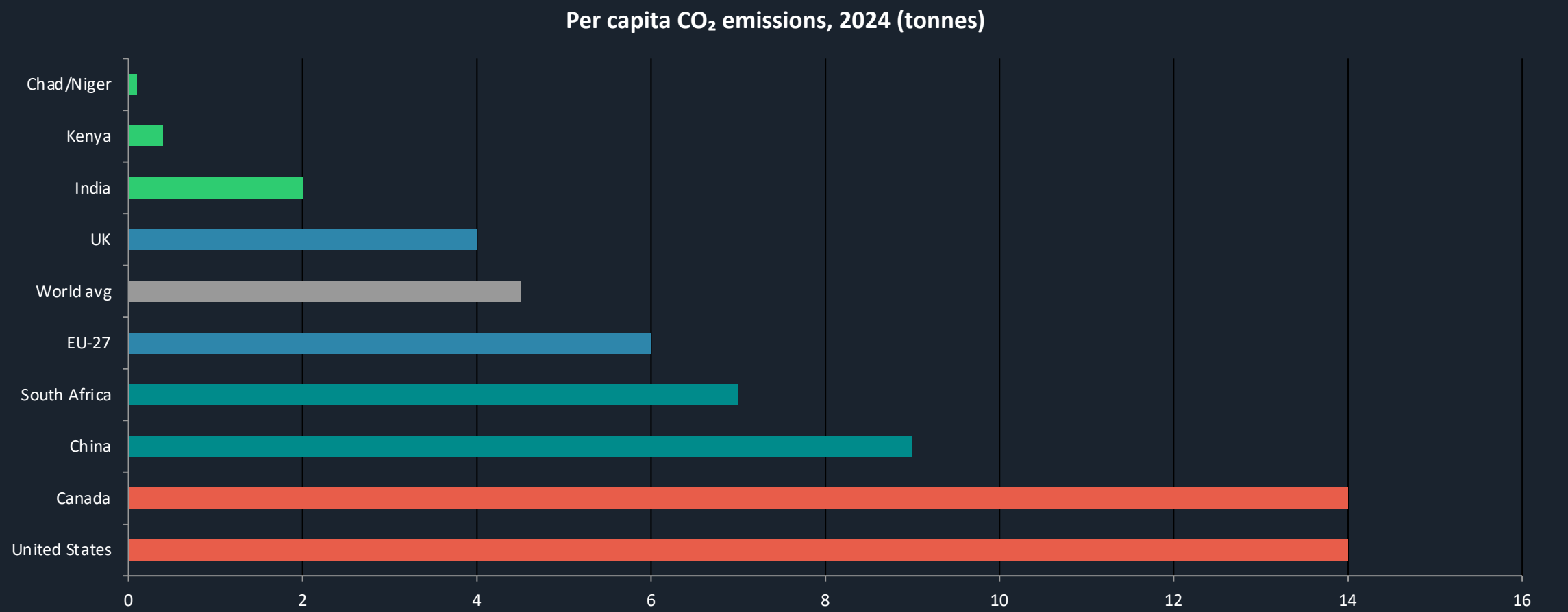


Per Capita Emissions Range from 0.1 t in Chad to ~14 t in the US and Canada



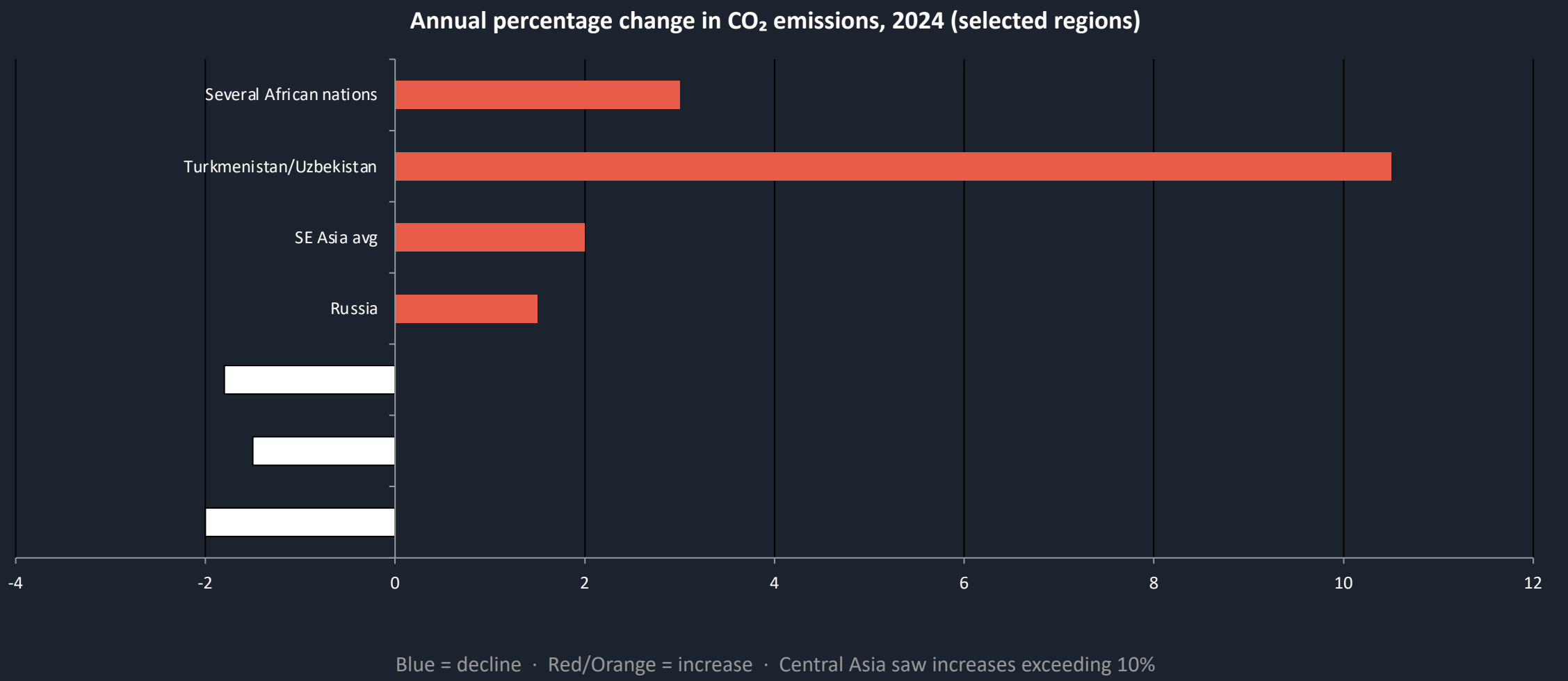
Gap: ~150× between lowest emitters (Chad/Niger ~0.1 t) and highest large-country emitters (US/Canada ~14 t)

Per Capita Emissions Vary Widely: ~14 t in the US vs. ~9 t in China and ~2 t in India

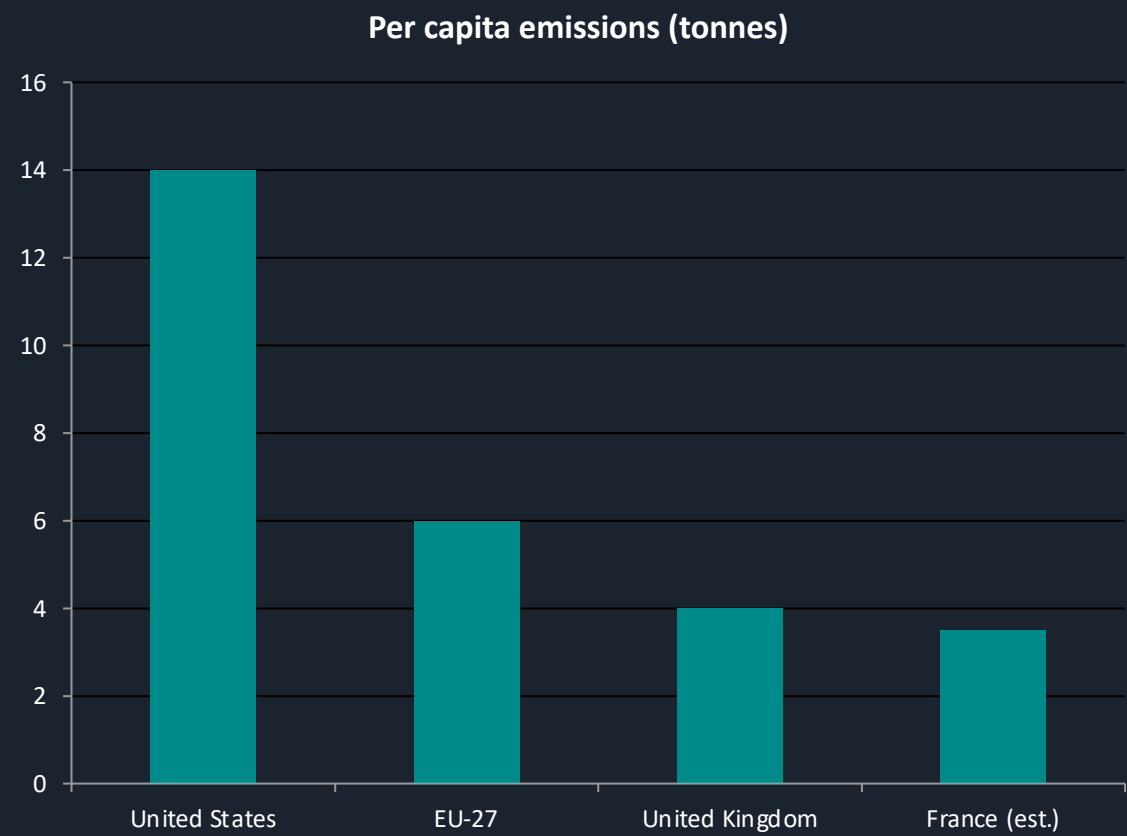


China remains below the US per capita despite being the largest total emitter · India at ~2 t remains well below world average

2024 Snapshot: Many Western Nations Cut Emissions While Parts of Asia and Africa Grew



Energy Mix Explains Why France and the UK Emit Far Less Per Capita Than Germany or the US



Key insight:

- France, the UK, and Portugal have much lower per capita emissions than Germany, the Netherlands, or the US.
- Reason: a higher share of electricity from nuclear and renewables rather than fossil fuels.
- This shows that prosperity and emissions can be decoupled through energy policy choices.

Key Takeaways: Responsibility Is Shared but Unequal

1. No peak yet — Global fossil CO₂ emissions exceed 35 Bt/yr and have not peaked, despite slowing growth.
2. China is the largest annual emitter (~31%) but its per capita emissions (~9 t) remain well below the US (~14 t).
3. Historical responsibility is dominated by Europe and the US (>90% in 1900), though their share is now <1/3.
4. Massive per capita inequality persists — a ~150× gap between the poorest nations (~0.1 t) and richest large-country emitters (~14 t).
5. Energy policy matters — countries with similar prosperity can have very different per capita emissions depending on nuclear and renewable share.